

Publishing Keyscape on Google Play

A complete step-by-step guide for first-time developers - from the US$25 account to your app going live

Everything you need: what has already been prepared in your project, every screen you will see in the Play Console, what to type in each field, the mandatory 14-day testing period, the realistic timeline, the costs, and the rules to keep in mind so your app is approved and stays on the store.

Keyscape 1.4.5 · package **com.keyscape.app** · Updated 11 October 2026 · Google's screens and rules change from time to time - where this guide and the Play Console differ, the Play Console wins.

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0 · At a glance

What it costs

- **US$25** one-time Google Play developer registration fee (pay by card).
- **Free** hosting for your privacy policy - GitHub Pages from your Keyscape repository.
- Optional: a real Android phone or tablet for testing (you probably already have one).
- No yearly fee. Google takes 15% of sales only if you ever charge money - Keyscape is free, so nothing.

How long it takes

- **Your active work:** about 4-6 hours spread over the weeks.
- **Calendar time:** typically **3 to 5 weeks** for a brand-new personal account, mainly because Google requires a **14-day closed test with at least 12 testers** before you may publish to everyone.
- Each Google review: usually hours to a few days; occasionally up to 7 days or longer.

What you upload

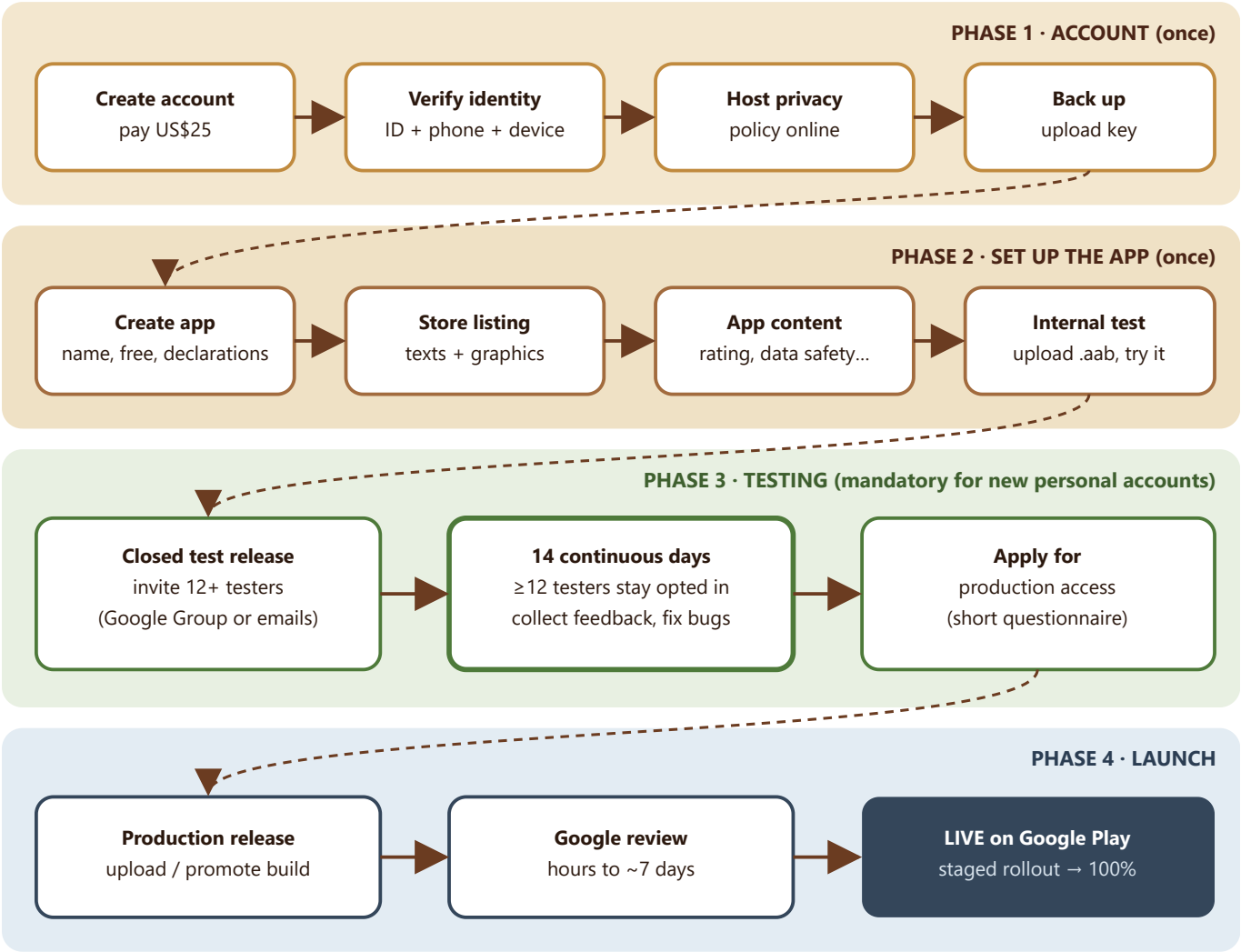
- `dist/Keyscape-1.4.5-play-store.aab` - the app bundle (already built and signed).
- Graphics from `docs/play-store/` (icon, feature graphic, 8 phone and 8 tablet screenshots).
- Texts from `docs/play-store/listing.md` (copy and paste).

What you need ready

- A Google account you will keep for years (ideally a dedicated one, e.g. *keyscape.dev@gmail.com*).
- A government photo ID (passport, Aadhaar, driving licence…) for identity verification.
- A phone number and a contact email.
- 12 or more friends or family with an Android phone who will install your test version.

1 The big picture

Publishing happens in four phases. Phases 1 and 2 are setup you do once; phase 3 is the mandatory testing period for new personal accounts; phase 4 is the public launch.

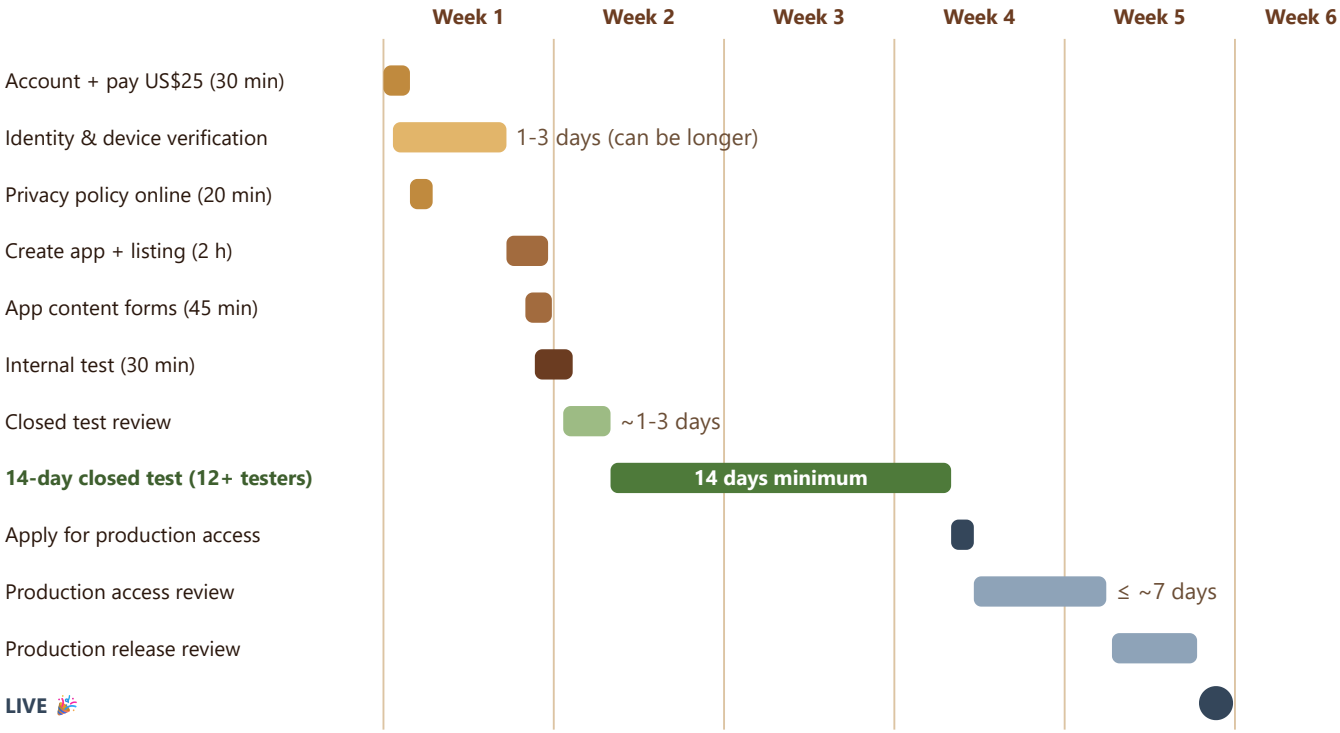


> **i** Words you will meet: **Play Console** = Google's website for publishing (play.google.com/console). **AAB** (Android App Bundle) = the file you upload. **Track** = a release channel (internal, closed, open, production). **Rollout** = making a release available to users.

> **i** If you register an **organization** account (a company with a D-U-N-S number), Google does not require the 14-day closed test - you can go from Phase 2 straight to Phase 4. For an individual, the personal account is simpler and the testing period is a good quality check anyway.

2 Timeline - how long it really takes

A realistic plan for a new **personal** developer account. Bars show calendar time; the numbers in brackets are your own hands-on time.



Milestone	Typical duration	What can slow it down
Identity verification	Minutes to 3 days	Blurry ID photo, name not matching the payment card, address mismatch.
Device verification (personal accounts)	Minutes	You need the **Play Console app** on an Android device signed in with the same account.
Each app review	Hours to ~7 days	First reviews of a new account are slowest; policy questions.
Closed test	**14 days, can't be shortened**	Testers dropping out - the clock needs 12 opted-in testers continuously.
Production access application	Usually ≤ 7 days	Vague answers about your testing. Be specific (see Step 10).

3 What is already done in your project

Google checks the app file automatically when you upload it. These technical requirements have all been prepared for you:

- ✅ **Android App Bundle** built in release mode: `dist/Keyscape-1.4.5-play-store.aab` (≈35 MB; Google's limit is 200 MB). Checked on 11 October 2026: signature verified, all tests pass.
- ✅ **Signed with your own upload key** (RSA-4096, valid ~27 years) - `keystore/pianoquest-upload.jks`. Release builds pick it up automatically through `keystore.properties`. (The certificate's internal name is "PianoQuest", the project's working title - users never see it, because Google re-signs the app.)
- ✅ **Target API level 36 (Android 16)** - meets Google's current rule for new apps; minimum Android 8.0 (API 26) so it runs on ~97% of active devices.
- ✅ **16 KB memory-page compatible** - the only native library (from AndroidX) is 16 KB aligned, as Google requires for apps targeting Android 15+.
- ✅ **No permissions requested** - no internet, location, contacts, storage or microphone access (verified in the built app: the only entry is an Android-internal permission that every modern app has). This makes the Data Safety form trivial and reviews smooth.
- ✅ **Package name is free** - on 11 October 2026 no app on Google Play used `com.keyscape.app`.
- ✅ **Code shrinking/obfuscation (R8)** enabled; **debuggable** turned off; version **1.4.5 (versionCode 13)**.
- ✅ **Privacy policy** written: `docs/privacy-policy.html` (you only need to put it online - Step 4). An in-app copy is under *More → About, privacy & licences*.
- ✅ **Licences and credits** for all music, samples, pictures and fonts are shown in the app (required by the Creative Commons licences).
- ✅ **Store graphics** in the right sizes and formats (24-bit PNG without transparency, as Google requires): app icon, feature graphic, 8 phone and 8 tablet screenshots in `docs/play-store/`.
- ✅ **Promo video**: `promo/out/keyscape-promo-sample2-1080p60.mp4` (2:16, 1080p60) with a ready YouTube title, description and thumbnail.
- ✅ **Source code on GitHub**: `github.com/Abhijay-Nagal/Keyscape` (the keystore and passwords are deliberately not in it).
- ✅ **Store texts and form answers**: `docs/play-store/listing.md`.

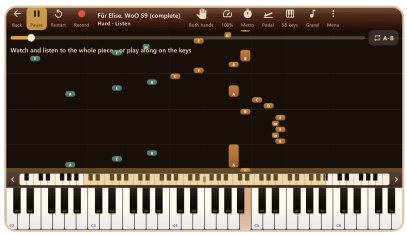
Your store graphics (already made)



App icon 512×512



Feature graphic 1024×500



Screenshot 1920×1080

> ❗ **Before you start, pick your final package name.** It is `com.keyscape.app`. Once you upload the first build, the package name can **never** be changed on Google Play. If you'd rather use something like `com.yourname.keyscape`, change `applicationId` in `composeApp/build.gradle.kts` and rebuild (Step 3) before uploading.

4 Step 1 - Create your developer account

US$25 one-time | 30 min + 1-3 days verification

Personal or organization?

	Personal account (recommended for you)	Organization account
Who	An individual	A registered company, NGO, school...
Extra documents	Government photo ID, phone, email	**D-U-N-S number** (free from Dun & Bradstreet, can take up to ~30 days), company website, official documents
14-day closed test	**Required** (12+ testers)	Not required
Public developer name	Your name or a chosen developer name	Company name

Do this

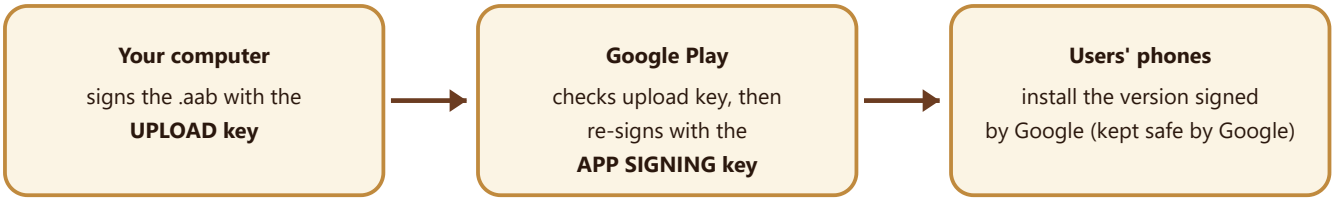
1. Create (or choose) a Google account you'll keep long-term. A dedicated account like *keyscape.studio@gmail.com* keeps things tidy. Turn on **2-Step Verification** (Google requires it for Play Console).
2. Go to **play.google.com/console/signup**. Choose **"Yourself"** (personal account).
3. Enter your **developer name** - shown publicly under your app (e.g. "Keyscape Studio" or your own name). Enter a **contact email** and **phone** for Google, and a **public contact email** for users (Google shows this on the store page).
4. Answer the short questions about your experience and plans (e.g. "1 app", "free", "education"). Accept the **Developer Distribution Agreement** and pay the **US$25** fee with a credit/debit card.
5. **Verify your identity**: upload a clear photo of a government ID. The name must match the one you entered (and ideally your payment card). Verify your phone number and email with the codes Google sends.
6. **Verify an Android device**: install the **Google Play Console** app from the Play Store on your Android phone, sign in with the same account, and follow the prompt. (Required for new personal accounts.)

✓ You'll get an email when verification completes. Meanwhile you can already prepare Steps 2-4 - they don't need the account.

! Use your **real legal name and details**. Fake or mismatching information is the most common reason accounts get suspended - and a suspended account can't simply be re-created.

5 Step 2 - Protect your upload key

10 min Every build you upload must be signed with the same **upload key**. Yours is ready in the `keystore` folder of the project.



This system is called **Play App Signing** and is mandatory for new apps. Because Google holds the real app-signing key, losing your upload key is *recoverable* (Google support can reset it), but it costs days of delay - so back it up now.

1. Open `keystore/README-KEEP-SAFE.txt` - it contains the key alias and the password.
2. Copy the whole `keystore` folder **and** the file `keystore.properties` to two safe places: e.g. an encrypted USB drive and a password manager (as attachments) or a private, encrypted cloud folder.
3. Save the password in your password manager too.

! Never put the `.jks` file or its password on GitHub, in an email or in a chat. They are already excluded from git via `.gitignore`. Your project folder lives in OneDrive - that is a backup, but make sure your Microsoft account has 2-step verification on.

i During the first upload, Play Console asks how to set up app signing. Choose the default: **"Use Google-generated key"** (Play App Signing). Nothing else to configure.

6 Step 3 - Build the app bundle (.aab)

5 min The current bundle is already built: `dist/Keyscape-1.4.5-play-store.aab`. You only need to rebuild when you change something (package name, code, content).

How to rebuild

Open a terminal (PowerShell) in the project folder and run:

```
cd C:\Users\HP\OneDrive\Desktop\my_projects\Keyscape
.\gradlew :composeApp:bundleRelease
```

The new bundle appears at `composeApp\build\outputs\bundle\release\composeApp-release.aab`. It is signed automatically with your upload key (thanks to `keystore.properties`).

Every update needs a higher version code

Google refuses a bundle whose **versionCode** was used before. Before each new upload, open `composeApp/build.gradle.kts` and raise both numbers:

```
defaultConfig {
    applicationId = "com.keyscape.app"
    versionCode = 14          // was 13 - always +1
    versionName = "1.4.6"     // what users see
}
```

Also update `packageVersion` (same file, Windows builds) and `VERSION` in `composeApp/src/commonMain/kotlin/com/pianoquest/app/AppInfo.kt` so the About screen matches.

Want to try the release build on your own phone first?

Use the ready-made `dist/Keyscape-1.4.5-android.apk` (signed with the same upload key): copy it to the phone and open it (allow "install unknown apps" once). Uninstall it before installing from Google Play later - the Play version is signed by Google's key, so Android treats them as different signatures.

! **Your phone already has this test build** (installed over USB while the promo video was made). Before you install Keyscape from the Play Store link in Step 8, **uninstall it** (long-press the icon → Uninstall), or the Play Store will say it cannot install the app. Uninstalling also clears the practice progress made during testing.

✓ Test on a real phone: play a few songs (Note Wait, Listen and Practice modes, all three guide modes), connect your MIDI keyboard, try Free Play with 88 keys, switch dark mode. Fix anything odd before the closed test - testers' first impression matters.

7 Step 4 - Publish the privacy policy online

20 min free Google requires a **public web link** to a privacy policy for every app - even apps like Keyscape that collect nothing. Your policy is written: `docs/privacy-policy.html`. You just need to host it.

Option A - GitHub Pages (recommended, 2 minutes)

The policy is already in your public repository at `docs/privacy-policy.html`.

1. Open **github.com/Abhijay-Nagal/Keyscape** → **Settings** → **Pages** (left menu).
2. Source: **Deploy from a branch**. Branch: **main**, folder: **/docs**. Click **Save**.
3. Wait 1-2 minutes, then open *https://abhijay-nagal.github.io/Keyscape/privacy-policy.html* - you should see "Keyscape - Privacy Policy".
4. That address is your privacy policy URL.

The repository must stay **public** for free GitHub Pages.

Option B - Google Sites

1. Go to **sites.google.com** → **Blank site**.
2. Title: "Keyscape Privacy Policy".
3. Open `privacy-policy.html` in your browser, select all text, copy, and paste it into the site.
4. Click **Publish**, choose a web address, make it public.
5. Copy the URL (e.g. *sites.google.com/view/keyscape-privacy*).

! The link must open a normal web page (not a PDF download, not a Google Doc that requires sign-in) and must mention the app name. Keep it online for as long as the app is published.

i The contact email in the policy is *nagalabhijay@gmail.com*. If you create a dedicated developer email, change it in both `privacy-policy.html` and the Play Console.

8 Step 5 - Create the app in Play Console

10 min In Play Console click **Create app** (top right of "All apps").

Create app (illustration - the real page may look slightly different)

App name	Keyscape: Learn Piano	max 30 characters
Default language	English (United States) - en-US	
App or game	● App ○ Game	
Free or paid	● Free ○ Paid	
Declarations	☑ Developer Program Policies ☑ US export laws	

Create app

! **Free is permanent.** Once an app is published as free it can never be changed to paid (you could add in-app purchases later). Keyscape is designed as a free app.

✓ Check the name isn't already used by a well-known app: search the Play Store for "Keyscape" first. If needed, pick a variant such as "Keyscape - Piano School". The store name can be changed later; the package name cannot.

After creating the app you land on the **Dashboard**. It shows a checklist titled "*Set up your app*" - Steps 6 and 7 of this guide complete that checklist.

9 Step 6 - Store listing

45 min Menu: **Grow users** → **Store presence** → **Main store listing**. Copy the texts from `docs/play-store/listing.md`.

Field	Requirement	Use this file / text
App name	≤ 30 characters	Keyscape: Learn Piano
Short description	≤ 80 characters	From listing.md
Full description	≤ 4000 characters	From listing.md
App icon	512 × 512 PNG, 32-bit, ≤ 1 MB	`icon-512.png`
Feature graphic	1024 × 500 JPG or 24-bit PNG (no transparency)	`feature-graphic-1024x500.png`
Phone screenshots	2-8 images, JPG / 24-bit PNG, 320-3840 px, ratio up to 2:1	The 8 `phone-1-player.png … phone-8-courses.png`, in number order (landscape 1920×1080 - the app runs in landscape)
7-inch and 10-inch tablet screenshots	Up to 8 each, 16:9, each side 1080-7680 px (recommended - tablets are shown separately)	The 8 `tablet-*.png` files (the app's real tablet layout) - upload the same 8 to both the 7-inch and 10-inch slots
Video	Optional YouTube link (public or unlisted, ads off, embedding allowed)	Upload `promo/out/keyscape-promo-sample2-1080p60.mp4` to YouTube using `promo/out/youtube-sample2.txt`, then paste the link

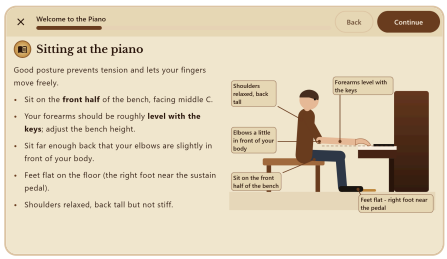
Also in Store presence

- **Store settings**: Category **Education**; tags: Music, Education; contact email (required) and optionally a website.
- **Countries / regions** (under *Production* → *Countries*): choose "All countries" or start with a few. Some countries need extra declarations - Play Console will tell you.

> ! **Metadata rules:** no ALL-CAPS hype, no "best"/"#1"/"free" in the title, no emojis spam, no other brands. **Do not mention "Perfect Piano"** or pop-artist names / song titles in the listing - Google can reject listings that use other people's trademarks. The provided texts already follow these rules (they only name classical composers, who are in the public domain).







10 Step 7 - App content declarations

45 min Menu: **Policy and programs** → **App content**. Each card needs to be completed once. Answers for Keyscape:

Declaration	Answer for Keyscape
Privacy policy	Paste your URL from Step 4.
App access	"All functionality is available without special access" (no login).
Ads	"No, my app does not contain ads".
Content rating	Start questionnaire → your email → category **"Reference, News, or Educational"** → answer **No** to violence, fear, sexuality, profanity, drugs, gambling, user-generated content, user interaction/chat, sharing location, digital purchases. Expected result: **Everyone / PEGI 3 / 3+**.
Target audience & content	Select ages **13-15, 16-17, 18+**. Answer that the app is not designed specifically for children. (Including under-13s is possible but triggers the stricter Families Policy review.)
News app	No.
COVID-19 tracing / status apps	Not applicable.
Data safety	"Does your app collect or share any of the required user data types?" → **No**. Then save and submit. (True because the app has no internet permission and no analytics - progress stays on the device.)
Government apps	No.
Financial features	"My app doesn't provide any financial features".
Health apps	"My app does not have health features".
Advertising ID	"No" - the app doesn't use the advertising ID (no ads SDK).

i If a card appears that isn't listed here (Google adds new ones occasionally), read it carefully: Keyscape has no accounts, no ads, no payments, no location and no data collection, so the answer is almost always "No / Not applicable".

! Answer truthfully. The Data Safety answer becomes the public "Data safety" section of your store page, and Google cross-checks it against the app.

11 Step 8 - Internal testing

30 min Internal testing is a private channel for up to 100 people that is available within minutes and usually doesn't need a review. Use it to check the uploaded build on your own phone.

1. **Test and release → Testing → Internal testing → Create new release.**
2. First time only: accept **Play App Signing** ("Use Google-generated key").
3. Upload `dist/Keyscape-1.4.5-play-store.aab`. Release name is filled automatically (1.4.5). Release notes: copy them from `listing.md` (section "Release notes").
4. **Testers** tab: create an email list with your own Gmail address (and a few friends). Save.
5. **Review release → Start rollout to Internal testing.**
6. Copy the **"Join on the web"** link from the Testers tab, open it on your phone, accept, and install from the Play Store.

✓ If Play Console shows **warnings** (yellow) after upload, read them - most are informational. **Errors** (red) block the release; see Troubleshooting (section 16).



The four release tracks. A build can be "promoted" from one track to the next without uploading it again.

12 Step 9 - Closed test: 12 testers × 14 days

14 days minimum Google requires new personal accounts to run a **closed test** with **at least 12 testers who stay opted in for at least 14 days in a row** before production access is unlocked.

Set it up

1. **Testing** → **Closed testing** → use the default track ("Alpha") → **Create release** → choose **Add from library** and pick the bundle you already uploaded (or upload it again). Add release notes.
2. **Testers**: easiest is a free **Google Group** (groups.google.com → Create group, e.g. *keyscape-testers@googlegroups.com*, set "Who can join: anyone with the link"). Add the group's email in Play Console. Alternatively add an email list.
3. Select countries (all), then **Review release** → **Start rollout to Closed testing**. This first closed release is reviewed by Google (usually 1-3 days).
4. Send testers **both links**: the Google Group link (to join) and the **opt-in link** from the Testers tab. Each tester must: join the group → open the opt-in link → tap **"Become a tester"** → install Keyscape from the Play Store link.

Finding 12+ testers

- Family and friends with Android phones - ask 15-20 to be safe in case someone drops out.
- Music teachers, piano students, choir or school groups - they'll also give useful feedback.
- Developer communities exchange testers (e.g. Reddit r/AndroidClosedTesting, "testers community" apps). Only use trustworthy sources.

During the 14 days

- [ ] Ask testers to **keep the app installed** and open it every few days (Google looks at real engagement).
- [ ] Collect feedback (Google Form or a WhatsApp group). Note what you fixed - you'll describe it in Step 10.
- [ ] If you fix bugs, upload a new build (higher versionCode) to the closed track - this does **not** reset the 14 days.
- [ ] Check **Dashboard**: it shows "X testers opted in" and the days counted.

> ! The clock needs **12 testers opted in continuously**. If someone leaves on day 10 and you drop to 11, the count can restart. Recruit spares.

13 Step 10 - Production access & launch

When the 14 days are done, the Dashboard shows **"Apply for production"**. You'll answer a short questionnaire. Be specific and honest - vague answers are the main cause of rejection.

Typical question	Example answer for Keyscape
How did you recruit testers?	"Friends, family and two local piano students; 16 testers joined through a Google Group."
How easy was it to recruit?	Choose honestly (e.g. "Neither easy nor difficult").
Describe the engagement	"Testers completed lessons in Piano Foundations, played songs in Note Wait, Listen and Practice modes, connected two USB MIDI keyboards, and used Free Play daily."
Feedback summary	"Requests for a bigger keyboard on small phones and a MIDI reconnect button; a crash when … was fixed in 1.1.1."
Who is the app for?	"Self-learners of all ages who want a complete piano course from beginner to advanced, with or without a digital piano."
How is it different / valuable?	"Structured courses (172 lessons), 222 pieces including 184 complete public-domain scores with Easy/Medium/Hard levels, MIDI keyboard support, no ads and no data collection."
Changes made from testing	List your real fixes (Step 9 notes).
Is the app ready for production?	Yes, and explain how you know (testing on several phones, no crashes in Android vitals).

Google typically answers within **7 days**. If declined, you'll get feedback; continue testing and apply again.

Launch

1. **Production** → **Create new release** → **Add from library** (the bundle your testers used) or upload the newest bundle.
2. Release notes, e.g. "*First release of Keyscape: 14 courses with 172 lessons, 222 pieces with Easy, Medium and Hard levels, three guide modes, practice tools, composer storybooks and USB MIDI keyboard support.*"
3. Optional but wise: **staged rollout** - start at 20%, watch for crashes for a day or two, then increase to 100%.
4. **Review release** → **Start rollout to Production.** Then open **Publishing overview** and click **Send for review** if changes are waiting.

✓ When approved you'll get an email and the app appears at **play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.keyscape.app**. It can take a few hours before it shows up in search.

14 After launch: updates & upkeep

Releasing an update

1. Make your changes; raise **versionCode** (+1) and **versionName** (Step 3).
2. Run `.\gradlew :composeApp:bundleRelease`.
3. Upload to **Closed testing** first if it's a big change, then promote to Production; small fixes can go straight to Production.
4. Use a staged rollout for larger updates.

Watch these regularly

Where	Why
Quality → Android vitals	Crash and "App not responding" rates. Google lowers visibility of apps with crash rates above ~1.09% or ANR rates above ~0.47%.
Ratings and reviews	Reply politely - replies are public and improve trust.
Inbox / email	Policy notices with deadlines. Missing a deadline can remove the app.
Statistics	Installs and uninstalls by country and device.

Yearly duties

- **Target API update:** Google raises the required target API every year (around 31 August). Keyscape targets API 36 now; plan to update to API 37 by **August 2027**. This needs a newer Android Gradle Plugin (version 9) - budget a day for it.
- **Re-confirm declarations** (Data safety, target audience) when Google asks.
- Keep the **privacy policy URL** online and your **contact details** current.
- Log in to Play Console at least once a year - inactive accounts can be closed.

> **i** Optional growth ideas: translate the store listing (Store presence → Translations), add a short promo video, create a custom store listing for countries, and ask happy users to leave a rating.

15 Rules to keep in mind

Intellectual property

Only publish content you have the right to use. Keyscape is prepared for this:

- Complete classical scores: public domain or Creative Commons (Mutopia Project), credited in the app.
- Grand-piano samples: Salamander (CC BY 3.0), credited.
- Pictures: public domain / CC0, credited.
- Modern pop songs: **chord progressions only** - never add copyrighted melodies, lyrics or recordings (e.g. full "River Flows in You" or "Shape of You" scores). That's a common reason for takedowns.
- MIDI files users import stay private on their own device.

Metadata & impersonation

- Don't use other apps' names ("Perfect Piano", "Simply Piano", "Yousician") or logos in the title, description or screenshots.
- Screenshots must show the real app.
- No fake reviews, no incentivised ratings, no keyword stuffing.

User data

- If you ever add analytics, crash reporting, ads, accounts or internet features, you **must** update the Data Safety form and the privacy policy **before** releasing that version.
- Adding the INTERNET permission alone changes nothing to report, but any SDK that sends data does.

Account health

- One account per person is enough - never create a second account to get around a suspension.
- Respond to Google within the deadlines in policy emails.
- Use accurate developer information.

Children

If you later choose an under-13 audience, the app must follow the **Families Policy** (no ads that aren't certified, no data collection). Keyscape already complies, but the review is stricter.

Money (if ever)

Charging or selling in-app content requires a **payments profile** (merchant account) and Google Play Billing. The free app as built needs none of this.

16 Troubleshooting & FAQ

Problem	Solution
"Version code 4 has already been used"	Raise `versionCode` in `composeApp/build.gradle.kts` and rebuild.
"The Android App Bundle was signed with the wrong key"	You built without `keystore.properties` (debug key). Make sure the file and the `keystore` folder are in the project root, then rebuild.
"Your app targets API level X, it must target at least Y"	Google raised the yearly requirement. Increase `targetSdk` / `compileSdk`, update the Android Gradle Plugin, rebuild and test.
"Package name already exists"	Another app uses `com.keyscape.app`. Change `applicationId` (e.g. `com.yourname.keyscape`) and rebuild.
Identity verification rejected	Re-upload a sharper photo; make sure name and address match exactly what you entered.
Closed-test day counter not moving	Check that ≥12 testers have **opted in** (not just been invited) and that the closed release is actually **published** (reviewed and available).
Production access declined	Read Google's feedback, keep testing (more engagement, more detailed notes), and re-apply after making improvements.
App rejected for "Metadata"	Remove other brand names, "best/#1", emojis or misleading claims from title/description; resubmit.
App rejected for "Intellectual property"	Remove the flagged content or provide proof of licence (the credits screen and Mutopia/Wikimedia links help).
Testers can't find the app	They must open the opt-in link while signed in with the invited Google account; it can take a few hours after rollout.
Lost the upload key	Play Console → **Setup** → **App signing** → request upload key reset; generate a new key with `keytool` and follow the instructions.

FAQ

Can I publish the Windows version on the Play Store? No - the Play Store is for Android (and ChromeOS, which runs your Android app). The Windows installer in `dist` could go to the Microsoft Store separately (one-time fee ~US$19 for individuals) - a different process.

Can I change the app after publishing? Yes - everything except the package name and "free" status. Upload a new version any time.

Will Google see my source code? No, only the compiled bundle.

Do I need a company or GST registration? Not for a free app on a personal account.

17 Master checklist

Before Play Console

- [ ] Decide final package name (keep `com.keyscape.app` or change it)
- [ ] Back up `keystore/` + `keystore.properties` + password
- [ ] Test `Keyscape-1.4.5-android.apk` on a real phone
- [ ] Switch on GitHub Pages; open the privacy policy URL
- [ ] Copy the privacy policy URL
- [ ] Create a dedicated Google account with 2-Step Verification

Account

- [ ] Sign up (personal) and pay US$25
- [ ] Verify identity (ID), phone and email
- [ ] Verify device with the Play Console app

App setup

- [ ] Create app (name, English, App, Free)
- [ ] Main store listing: texts + icon + feature graphic + phone and tablet screenshots
- [ ] Promo video on YouTube, link in the listing (optional)
- [ ] Store settings: Education category, contact email
- [ ] Privacy policy URL
- [ ] App access, Ads, Content rating, Target audience
- [ ] Data safety (No data collected), News, Government, Financial, Health, Advertising ID
- [ ] Countries / regions

Testing

- [ ] Uninstall the USB test build from your phone
- [ ] Internal testing release with the .aab; install it yourself
- [ ] Create Google Group for testers
- [ ] Closed testing release; rollout; wait for review
- [ ] Recruit 15-20 testers; all opted in and installed
- [ ] 14 continuous days with ≥12 testers
- [ ] Collect feedback; fix and upload new builds if needed

Launch

- [ ] Apply for production access (detailed answers)
- [ ] Production release with release notes
- [ ] Staged rollout 20% → 100%
- [ ] Confirm the store page is live

Ongoing

- [ ] Check Android vitals and reviews weekly
- [ ] Answer policy emails before deadlines
- [ ] Raise versionCode for every update
- [ ] Target API 37 before August 2027

18 Where everything is in your project

Project folder: `C:\Users\HP\OneDrive\Desktop\my_projects\Keyscape` · on GitHub: `github.com/Abhijay-Nagal/Keyscape`

Path	What it is
`dist/Keyscape-1.4.5-play-store.aab`	The file you upload to Google Play
`dist/Keyscape-1.4.5-android.apk`	Same build as an installable APK for testing on your phone
`keystore/pianoquest-upload.jks`	Your upload key - back it up, keep it secret
`keystore/README-KEEP-SAFE.txt`	Alias and password of the upload key
`keystore.properties`	Tells the build where the key is (secret)
`docs/privacy-policy.html`	Privacy policy to host online
`docs/play-store/listing.md`	Store texts and all form answers
`docs/play-store/*.png`	Icon, feature graphic, phone and tablet screenshots
`promo/out/`	Promo video, thumbnail, captions and YouTube text (not on GitHub - too large)
`dist/`, `keystore/`, `keystore.properties`	Builds and signing secrets - on this computer only, never on GitHub. Back them up.
`composeApp/build.gradle.kts`	Package name, versionCode/versionName, target SDK
`composeApp/src/commonMain/.../AppInfo.kt`	Version shown in the About screen
`README.md`	Project overview and build commands

Build commands (PowerShell, in the project folder)

```
.\gradlew :composeApp:bundleRelease      # Play Store bundle (.aab)
.\gradlew :composeApp:assembleRelease    # installable .apk
.\gradlew :composeApp:desktopTest        # run all automated tests
```

✓ You're ready. Start with Step 1 today - while Google verifies your identity, finish Steps 2-4. Then it's mostly waiting for the 14-day test. Good luck with the launch!